YO TOURS · AUDIO GUIDE

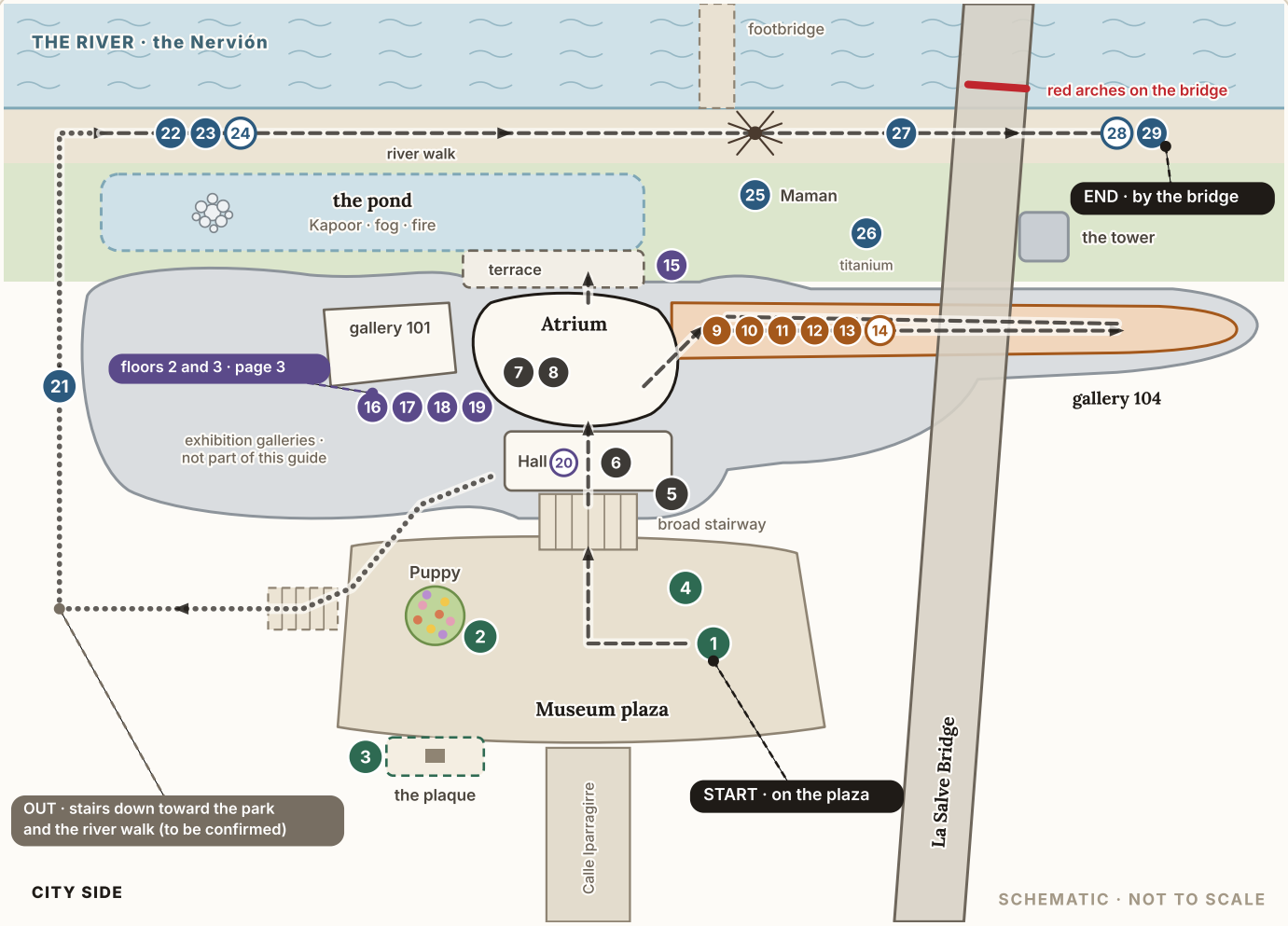
Guggenheim Museum Bilbao

The building, inside and out, and the works that live here: 25 main stops plus 4 short Extras in one walking order, in three lengths.

1 **Plaza, inside, then the river.** Puppy and the plaza first, down the broad stairway, the Atrium and Serra's long gallery, up to the balconies, then out and round to the river walk, along the water to the bridge.

2 The coloured circle is the track to play there, in track order. Hollow circles are short, optional Extras, on the Full tour only. Pages 2 to 4 show every track in its place.

3 Each track ends by telling you where to go next. This is a schematic plan, not to scale. **Dashed and dotted: not yet confirmed on site.**



1 Full tour

about 1 h 40 · 29 tracks

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29

every stop, with ZERO, Holzer's columns, all of Serra, both balconies and the 4 Extras

2 Essential

about 1 h 15 · 19 tracks

1 2 3 4 7 9 10 13 15 17 18 19 21 22 23 25 26 27 29

the plaza and the plaque, the Atrium, Serra on foot, the terrace, the flower, the river walk

3 Highlights

about 45 min · 9 tracks

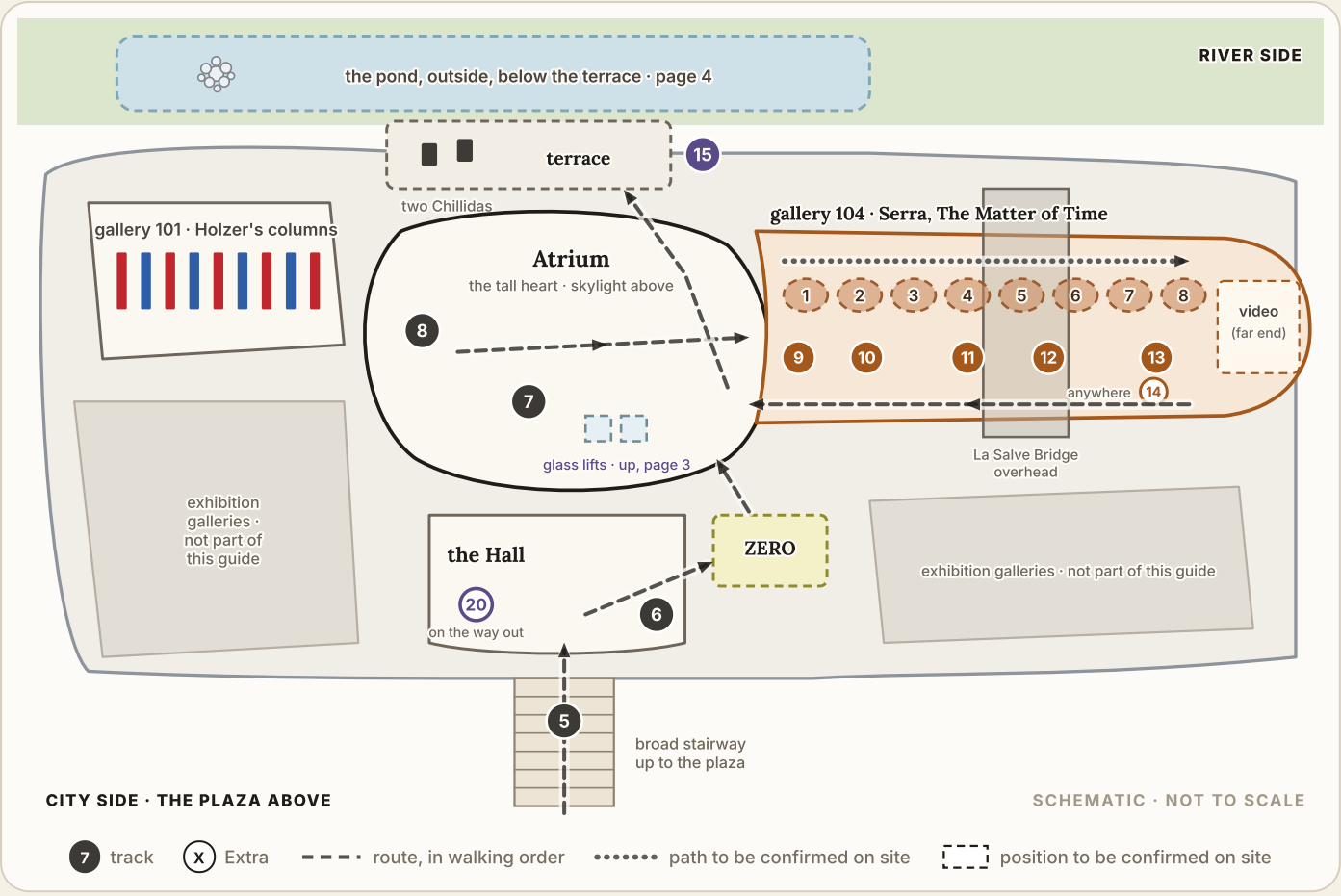
1 2 4 7 9 18 25 27 29

Puppy, the Atrium, Serra's gallery, the flower, Maman, the bridge

Two timings only: the fog in the pond runs on the hour; the fire fountains burn only in the evening. The changing exhibitions are not part of this guide; you will walk past some of them. Times include walking and the lifts, not queues or waiting for the fog. In the shorter versions the track numbers jump, and every stop tells you where to go next.

Inside, floor 1 · 5 to 15

Down the broad stairway into the Hall (5), ZERO in the lobby (6), the Atrium (7) and Holzer's columns in gallery 101 (8), then Serra's long gallery 104, under La Salve Bridge (9, 10, 11, 12, 13 and 14), and the terrace on the river side (15). The museum calls this level floor 1; the plaza outside is one floor higher.



5 **The broad stairway down to the Hall (heard walking)**
Going down to go in

6 **The Hall · outside ZERO**
The room that multiplies

7 **Atrium · floor 1, near the middle**
The heart of the building

8 **Atrium · facing gallery 101**
Holzer's columns of light

9 **Gallery 104 · just inside the entrance**
The gallery under the bridge

10 **Gallery 104 · the first sculptures**
Walls that lean

11 **Gallery 104 · Snake**
Snake waited eight years

12 **Gallery 104 · the spirals**
Lost on purpose

13 **Gallery 104 · the far end**
Torus and sphere

14 **Gallery 104 (anywhere, e.g. the walk back)**
Extra The Serra that vanished

15 **Atrium terrace**
Chillida and the river

The eight Serras, in order

1 Torqued Spiral (Closed Open Closed Open Closed)
2 Torqued Ellipse
3 Double Torqued Ellipse
4 Snake
5 Torqued Spiral (Right Left)
6 Torqued Spiral (Open Left Closed Right)
7 Between the Torus and the Sphere
8 Blind Spot Reversed

Expected order from the Atrium end; only the sequence is drawn. Read the labels.

Gallery 104

The long gallery that opens off the Atrium and runs under the bridge. Play 9 just inside, then walk the sculptures in order to the far end, where there is an educational space with a video. The gallery appears to be a dead end: walk back the same way to the Atrium (14 is an Extra for anywhere in 104).

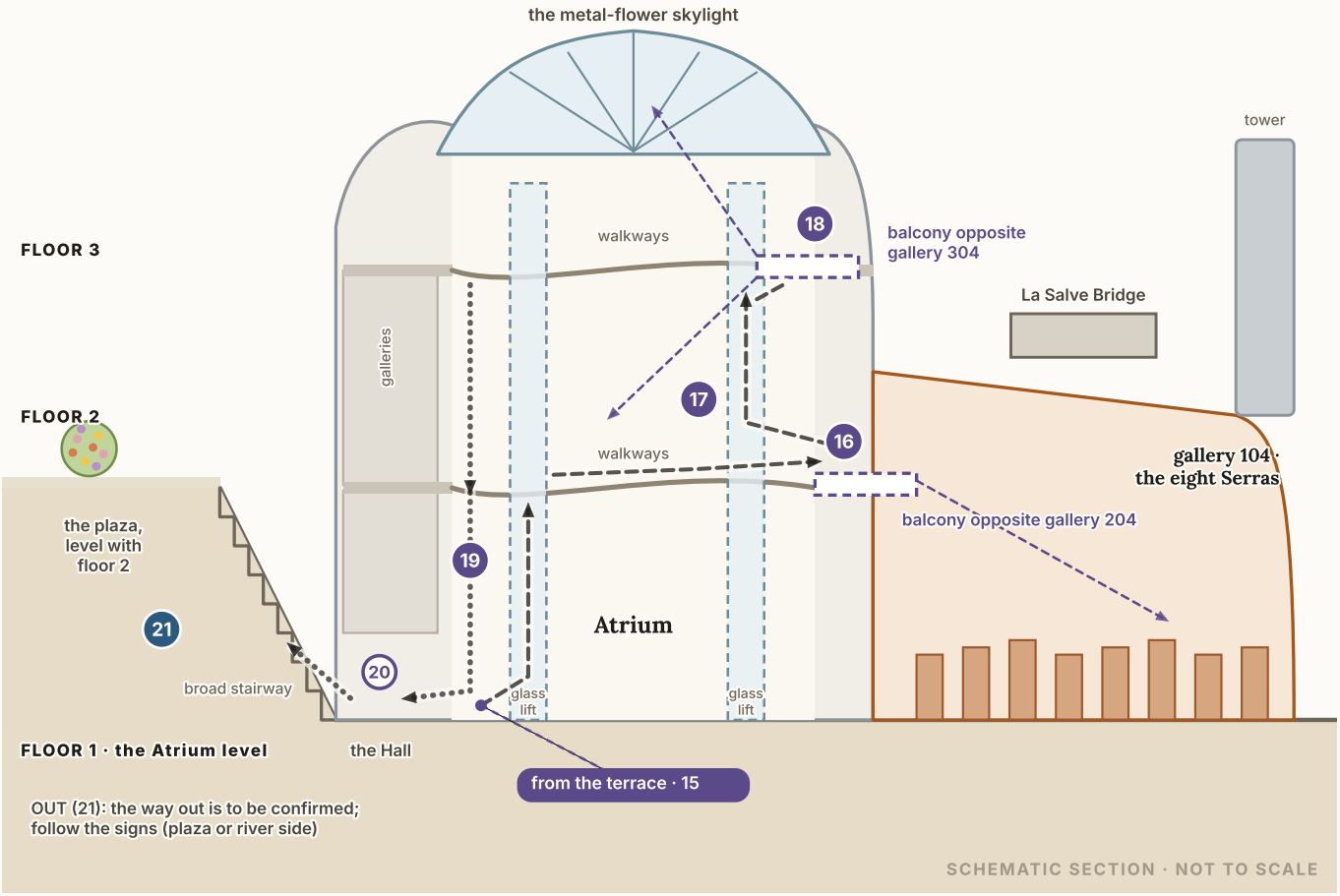
The Hall, the Atrium, the terrace

Play 5 walking down the broad stairway, 6 outside the door of ZERO, the small room in the lobby. In the Atrium, 7 near the middle, 8 where you can see into gallery 101. After 104, the terrace on the river side (15); then back in and up. The way out is still to be confirmed: follow the signs.

YO TOURS · GUGGENHEIM BILBAO · FLOORS 2 AND 3

Up and down · 16 to 21

A cut through the building: the plaza is level with floor 2, the Hall and the Atrium are on floor 1. Up a glass lift to the balcony opposite gallery 204, over Serra (16); the lifts and walkways (17); the balcony opposite gallery 304, under the metal flower (18); down again (19, Extra 20) and out (21).



16 **Second floor · balcony opposite gallery 204**
Serra from above

17 **Glass lifts and walkways (heard moving)**
Every piece different

18 **Third floor · balcony opposite gallery 304**
The metal flower

19 **Going down to the Hall (heard moving)**
The Bilbao effect

20 **The Hall**
Extra Opening day, 1997

21 **Outside · on the way to the river walk (heard walking)**
From shipyards to river walk

Serra from above (16)

From the terrace, go back into the Atrium and take a glass lift or the stairs to the second floor. The balcony opposite gallery 204 looks down into gallery 104 and all eight sculptures. Highlights: a look from here on the way up, with no track. If the balcony is closed, go on up.

Up to the flower (17, 18)

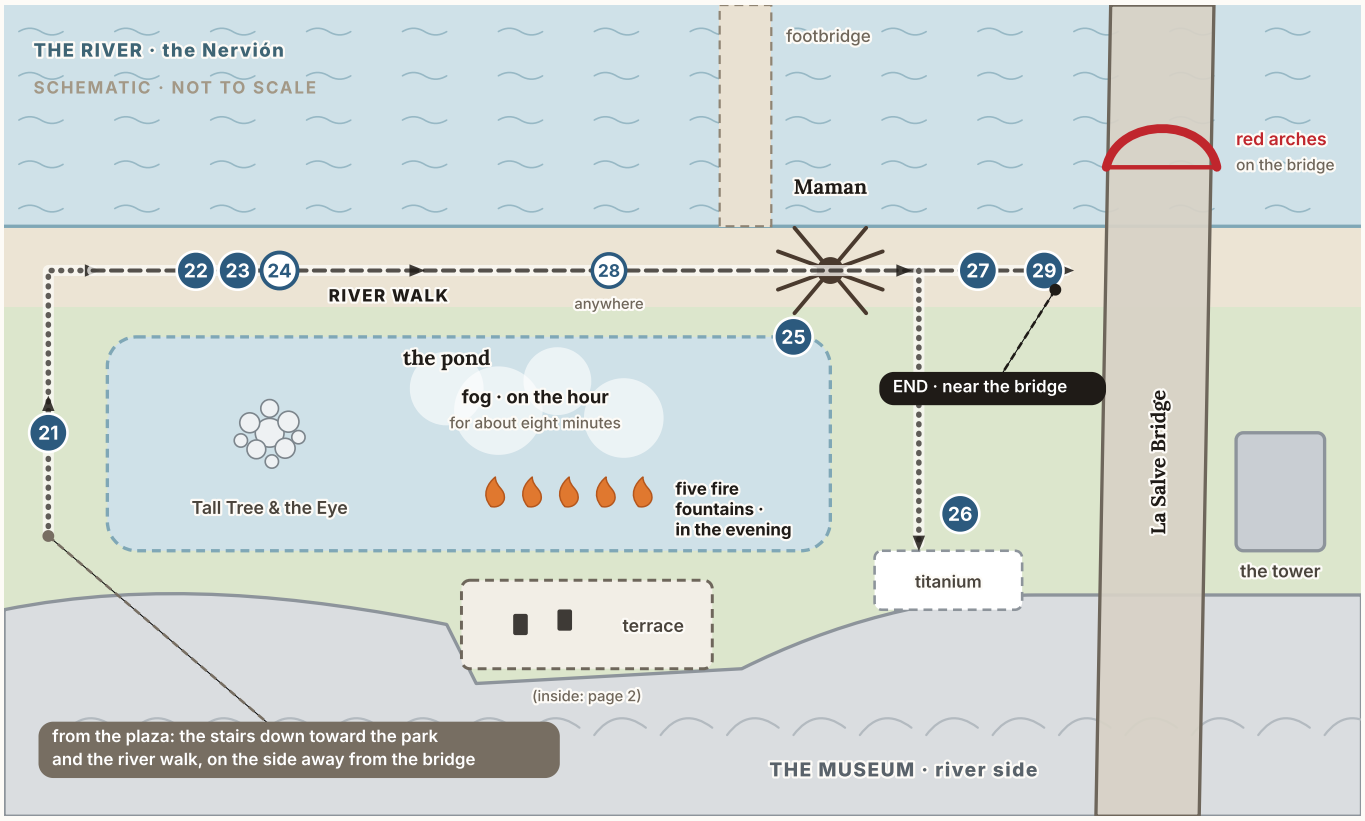
Start 17 in a glass lift as the doors close, or on the curved walkways and stairs. On the third floor, the balcony opposite gallery 304 looks out over the Atrium to the great metal-flower skylight. The galleries around are not stops.

Down and out (19, 20, 21)

Play 19 on the way down to the Hall by a lift or the stairs; Extra 20 in the Hall. Then leave and play 21 as you go: it tells you the way to the river walk. Which door visitors leave by is still to be checked on site.

The river walk · 21 to 29

Out and round to the river (21), then along the water toward the bridge: the pond with Kapoor's tree, the fog and the fire (22, 23 and 24), Maman by the footbridge (25), the titanium up close (26), La Salve Bridge with the tower and Buren's red arches (27), and the end by the bridge (29). The order of the pond and Maman is still to be checked on site.



21 **Outside · on the way to the river walk (heard walking)**
From shipyards to river walk

22 **River walk · by the pond**
Tall Tree & the Eye

23 **River walk · by the pond**
Frank O. Gehry's fog

24 **River walk · by the pond**
Extra Fire on the water

25 **River walk · Maman**
Maman

26 **River walk · beside the titanium**
Titanium, stone and glass

27 **River walk · La Salve Bridge, the tower in view**
The bridge, the tower and the red arches

28 **River walk (anywhere; ideally with a view across the water)**
Extra The ones who lost

29 **River walk · by La Salve Bridge**
"We all need love"

The pond (22, 23 and 24)

Walk along the water toward the big road bridge to the pond beside the building, with the tall tree of silver balls in it. The fog rises from this water on the hour, for about eight minutes. The five fire fountains, in the same pond, burn only in the evening.

Maman and the titanium (25, 26)

Maman stands by the footbridge, toward the bridge: stay on the path around her. Then find a spot where the titanium skin comes close to the path, ideally with limestone and glass in the same view. Look, don't touch.

The bridge, the end (27, 28, 29)

Stop where La Salve Bridge, the tall tower beside it and the red frame on the bridge are all in view. Extra 28 plays anywhere on the river walk. The last stop: a quiet place near the bridge, with the museum beside you.

YO TOURS · GUGGENHEIM BILBAO · ALL STOPS

The stops

Every track in walking order: # on your player, the title, where to play it, main stop or Extra, and the lengths it belongs to (Full, about 1 h 40; Essential, about 1 h 15; Highlights, about 45 min; walking included). Hollow circles are Extras, on the Full tour only.

#	TITLE	WHERE TO PLAY IT	TYPE	FULL	ESSEN-TIAL	HIGH-LIGHTS
The plaza						
1	**Welcome to the Guggenheim Bilbao**	Museum plaza · Puppy in view	main	●	●	●
2	**Puppy, the guard dog in bloom**	Museum plaza · facing Puppy	main	●	●	●
3	**Txema Agirre**	Museum plaza · the Txema Agirre plaque	main	●	●	·
4	**"Our town is dying"**	Museum plaza · facing the building, Calle Iparragirre behind you	main	●	●	●
Going in						
5	**Going down to go in**	The broad stairway down to the Hall (heard walking)	main	●	·	·
6	**The room that multiplies**	The Hall · outside ZERO	main	●	·	·
7	**The heart of the building**	Atrium · floor 1, near the middle	main	●	●	●
8	**Holzer's columns of light**	Atrium · facing gallery 101	main	●	·	·
Serra · gallery 104						
9	**The gallery under the bridge**	Gallery 104 · just inside the entrance	main	●	●	●
10	**Walls that lean**	Gallery 104 · the first sculptures	main	●	●	·
11	**Snake waited eight years**	Gallery 104 · Snake	main	●	·	·
12	**Lost on purpose**	Gallery 104 · the spirals	main	●	·	·
13	**Torus and sphere**	Gallery 104 · the far end	main	●	●	·
14	**The Serra that vanished**	Gallery 104 (anywhere, e.g. the walk back)	Extra	●	·	·
Terrace, up and down						
15	**Chillida and the river**	Atrium terrace	main	●	●	·
16	**Serra from above**	Second floor · balcony opposite gallery 204	main	●	·	·
17	**Every piece different**	Glass lifts and walkways (heard moving)	main	●	●	·
18	**The metal flower**	Third floor · balcony opposite gallery 304	main	●	●	●
19	**The Bilbao effect**	Going down to the Hall (heard moving)	main	●	●	·
20	**Opening day, 1997**	The Hall	Extra	●	·	·
The river walk						
21	**From shipyards to river walk**	Outside · on the way to the river walk (heard walking)	main	●	●	·
22	**Tall Tree & the Eye**	River walk · by the pond	main	●	●	·
23	**Frank O. Gehry's fog**	River walk · by the pond	main	●	●	·
24	**Fire on the water**	River walk · by the pond	Extra	●	·	·
25	**Maman**	River walk · Maman	main	●	●	●
26	**Titanium, stone and glass**	River walk · beside the titanium	main	●	●	·
27	**The bridge, the tower and the red arches**	River walk · La Salve Bridge, the tower in view	main	●	●	●
28	**The ones who lost**	River walk (anywhere; ideally with a view across the water)	Extra	●	·	·
29	**"We all need love"**	River walk · by La Salve Bridge	main	●	●	●
Tracks · visit time, walking and lifts included				**29** ≈ 1 h 40	**19** ≈ 1 h 15	**9** ≈ 45 min